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1. Formation

Our primary formation is **4-3-3 (Attack)**. We operate with a high defensive line and compact midfield block. The three forwards press aggressively in the opposition half, with the striker leading the press from the front. The three central midfielders provide the engine room — one holding midfielder protects the back four while two box-to-box midfielders carry play forward.

2. Pressing System — High Press

Our press is triggered by a designated signal from the holding midfielder. Key principles:

- The striker must lead the press from the front — intercepting the goalkeeper's distribution and pressing centre-backs aggressively. Stamina ≥ 80 and sprint speed ≥ 78 are non-negotiable for this role.
- Wingers tuck inside to create a pressing trap on the flanks, preventing progression through wide areas.
- When the press is beaten, the team drops into a compact 4-5-1 mid-block at 60% of the pitch.
- Pressing triggers: goalkeeper in possession, opposition defender under pressure, or wayward back-pass.
- The team aims to win the ball within 6 seconds of losing it (GEGENPRESSING principle).

3. Build-Up Play — Possession Based

In possession, we build from the back through short, triangular combinations. The goalkeeper distributes to the centre-backs, who split wide. The holding midfielder drops between the centre-backs to form a back three in possession, freeing the full-backs to advance high up the pitch.

- Pass accuracy requirement: all outfield players should achieve $\geq 78\%$ in our system.
- The centre-backs must be comfortable receiving under pressure and playing forward passes.
- When the build-up is blocked centrally, we switch to the opposite full-back who overlaps.
- Our target is $> 55\%$ possession in league games.

4. Attacking Patterns

We use three primary attacking patterns:

Pattern A — Inside Run: The left winger cuts inside onto their stronger foot while the left-back overlaps into the space. The striker makes a near-post run. The left winger must have `dribble_success` ≥ 75 to execute this reliably.

Pattern B — Striker Hold-Up: When we can't build from the back, the striker receives long balls and holds up play for the midfielders to join. Aerial duel win rate $\geq 70\%$ is required for this to be effective.

Pattern C — Counter Attack: On turnovers in the opponent's half, the fastest winger runs in behind immediately. Sprint speed ≥ 85 is needed for the wingers to exploit counter-attack opportunities effectively.

5. Set Pieces

- Corners: Delivery to the near post. Striker and one centre-back attack the near post. Second striker / CAM arrives late at the far post.
- Free kicks (wide): Low ball into the penalty area — striker makes a bending run across the near post.
- Defensive set pieces: Zonal marking — centre-backs take the central zone, CDM guards the edge.
- Players with `aerial_duels_won` ≥ 75 are prioritised for set-piece duty.

6. Key Player Requirements by Role

Role	Min Stats Required	Key Trait
Striker (ST)	Goals/ssn ≥ 15 , Aerial ≥ 70 , Pace ≥ 78	Press leader + finisher
Left Winger (LW)	Dribble ≥ 75 , Pace ≥ 85 , Goals ≥ 10	Cut inside + create
Right Winger (RW)	Dribble ≥ 75 , Pace ≥ 85 , Goals ≥ 10	Wide outlet + cross
CM (Box-to-Box)	Stamina ≥ 82 , Pass% ≥ 82 , Goals ≥ 5	Engine room
CDM (Holder)	Defending ≥ 80 , Aerial ≥ 72 , Pass% ≥ 85	Shield backline
Centre-Back (CB)	Defending ≥ 83 , Aerial ≥ 78 , Pass% ≥ 78	Ball-playing CB
Full-Back (LB/RB)	Pace ≥ 76 , Assists ≥ 4 /ssn, Defending ≥ 72	Attacking FB

7. Summary Philosophy

FC Antigravity plays an attractive, high-intensity brand of football built on pressing, possession, and vertical transitions. Every signing must contribute to this philosophy. Athletic players with technical quality are prioritised over technically gifted players who lack the physical capacity to press and counter-press at the required intensity. A player's tactical intelligence — knowing when to press, when to hold, when to run in behind — is weighted equally alongside raw statistics.